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(54) **PETUNIA PLANT NAMED**
‘WNPETSMVPC26’

(50) Latin Name: *Petunia X hybrida*
Varietal Denomination: **WNPETSMVPC26**

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(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./356.21**
CPC **A01H 6/824** (2018.05)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
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See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct *Petunia* plant named ‘WNPETSMVPC26’, characterized by its relatively compact, upright to somewhat outwardly spreading and mounding plant habit; vigorous growth habit and rapid growth rate; freely branching habit; dense and bushy plant form; early and freely flowering habit; single-type flowers that are purplish pink in color with white-colored throats; and excellent container and garden performance.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical designation: *Petunia X hybrida*.
Cultivar denomination: ‘WNPETSMVPC26’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar of *Petunia* plant, botanically known as *Petunia X hybrida* and hereinafter referred to by the name ‘WNPETSMVPC26’.

The new *Petunia* plant is a product of a planned breeding program conducted by the Inventor in Alajuela, Costa Rica and Mustang Ridge, Texas. The objective of the breeding program is to create new vigorous, freely-branching and uniformly mounding *Petunia* plants with early and freely flowering habit, attractive flowers and good garden performance.

The new *Petunia* plant originated from a cross-pollination made by the Inventor on Feb. 10, 2021 in Alajuela, Costa Rica of *Petunia X hybrida* ‘BHTUN98901’, disclosed in U.S. Plant Pat. No. 30,965, as the female, or seed, parent with *Petunia X hybrida* ‘BBTUN91601M2’, disclosed in U.S. Plant Pat. No. 32,641, as the male, or pollen, parent. The new *Petunia* plant was discovered and selected by the Inventor as a single flowering plant within the progeny of the stated cross-pollination in a controlled greenhouse environment in Mustang Ridge, Texas on Sep. 21, 2021.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Petunia* plant by vegetative terminal cuttings in a controlled greenhouse environment in Mustang Ridge, Texas since Oct. 4, 2021 has shown that the unique features of this new *Petunia* plant are stable and reproduced true to type in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Plants of the new *Petunia* have not been observed under all possible combinations of environmental conditions and cultural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with

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variations in environmental conditions such as temperature and light intensity without, however, any variance in genotype.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and are determined to be the unique characteristics of ‘WNPETSMVPC26’. These characteristics in combination distinguish ‘WNPETSMVPC26’ as a new and distinct *Petunia* plant:

1. Relatively compact, upright to somewhat outwardly spreading and mounding plant habit.
2. Vigorous growth habit and rapid growth rate.
3. Freely branching habit; dense and bushy plant form.
4. Early and freely flowering habit.
5. Single-type flowers that are purplish pink in color with white-colored throats.
6. Excellent container and garden performance.

Plants of the new *Petunia* can be compared to plants of the female parent, ‘BHTUN98901’. In side-by-side comparisons, plants of the new *Petunia* differ primarily from plants of ‘BHTUN98901’ in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Petunia* are more compact than plants of ‘BHTUN98901’.
2. Plants of the new *Petunia* are more mounding than and not as outwardly spreading as plants of ‘BHTUN98901’.
3. Plants of the new *Petunia* have smaller flowers than plants of ‘BHTUN98901’.
4. Plants of the new *Petunia* have flowers that are purplish pink in color with white-colored throats whereas flowers of plants of ‘BHTUN98901’ are dark red purple in color.

Plants of the new *Petunia* can be compared to plants of the male parent, ‘BBTUN91601M2’. In side-by-side comparisons, plants of the new *Petunia* differ primarily from plants of ‘BBTUN91601M2’ in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Petunia* are more compact than plants of 'BBTUN91601M2'.
2. Plants of the new *Petunia* are more mounding than and not as outwardly spreading as plants of 'BBTUN91601M2'.
3. Plants of the new *Petunia* have smaller flowers than plants of 'BBTUN91601M2'.
4. Flowers of plants of the new *Petunia* are purplish pink in color with white-colored throats whereas flowers of plants of 'BHTUN91601M2' are dark red purple and white bi-colored.

Plants of the new *Petunia* can be compared to plants of *Petunia* X *hybrida* 'USTUN2401M', disclosed in U.S. Plant Pat. No. 29,664. In side-by-side comparisons, plants of the new *Petunia* differ primarily from plants of 'USTUN2401M' in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Petunia* are more compact than plants of 'USTUN2401M'.
2. Plants of the new *Petunia* have smaller flowers than plants of 'USTUN2401M'.
3. Flowers of plants of the new *Petunia* are purplish pink in color with white-colored throats whereas flowers of plants of 'USTUN2401M' are solid hot pink in color.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying colored photographs illustrate the overall appearance of the new *Petunia* plant showing the colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions of this type. Colors in the photographs may differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the colors of the new *Petunia* plant.

The photograph on the first sheet (FIG. 1) is a side perspective view of a typical flowering plant of 'WNPETSMVPC26' grown in a container.

The photograph on the second sheet (FIG. 2) is a close-up view of a typical flower of 'WNPETSMVPC26'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photographs and following observations and measurements describe plants grown during the late summer to early autumn in 813 ml containers in a glass-covered greenhouse in Loudon, New Hampshire and under cultural practices typical of commercial *Petunia* production. During the production of the plants, day temperatures ranged from 18° C. to 20° C. and night temperatures ranged from 16° C. to 18° C. Plants were pinched one time and were eight weeks from planting rooted young plants when the photographs and description were taken. In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 2015 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Botanical classification: *Petunia* X *hybrida* 'WNPETSMVPC26'.

Parentage:

Female, or seed, parent.—*Petunia* X *hybrida* 'BHTUN98901', disclosed in U.S. Plant Pat. No. 30,965.

Male, or pollen, parent.—*Petunia* X *hybrida* 'BBTUN91601M2', disclosed in U.S. Plant Pat. No. 32,641.

Propagation:

Type.—Terminal vegetative cuttings.

Time to initiate roots, summer.—About three to four days at ambient temperatures about 28° C.

Time to initiate roots, winter.—About five to seven days at ambient temperatures about 20° C.

Time to produce a rooted plant, summer.—About three or four weeks at ambient temperatures about 28° C.

Time to produce a rooted plant, winter.—About four to five weeks at ambient temperatures about 20° C.

Root description.—Fine, fibrous; typically white in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on substrate composition, water quality, fertilizer type and formulation, substrate temperature and physiological age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Freely branching; medium density.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Relatively compact, upright to somewhat outwardly spreading and mounding plant habit; freely branching habit with primary lateral branches with secondary laterals developing potentially at every node, dense and bushy plant form; pinching enhances development of lateral branches; vigorous growth habit and rapid growth rate.

Plant height.—About 13 cm to 15 cm.

Plant diameter (area of spread).—About 28 cm to 33 cm.

Lateral branches.—Length: About 16 cm to 18 cm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Internode length: About 1.2 cm to 1.4 cm. Strength: Strong; flexible, not brittle. Aspect: Initially upright then outwardly spreading. Texture and luster: Densely pubescent; pubescence, fine; slightly to moderately glossy. Color, developing and developed: Close to 144A.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Alternate before flowering; opposite after flowers develop; leaves simple.

Length.—About 3 cm to 3.2 cm.

Width.—About 1.2 cm to 1.4 cm.

Shape.—Lanceolate.

Apex.—Rounded acute.

Base.—Cuneate with obtuse tendencies.

Margin.—Entire; slightly recurved; not undulate.

Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces.—Moderately pubescent, pubescence, minute; slightly glossy.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate, arcuate.

Color.—Developing leaves, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 146A. Fully developed leaves, upper surface: Close to 146A; venation, close to 146A to 146B. Fully developed leaves, lower surface: Close to 146B; venation, close to 144A.

Petioles.—Length: About 6 mm to 8 mm. Diameter: About 1.5 mm to 2 mm. Strength: Moderately strong, flexible. Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Moderately pubescent; slightly glossy. Color, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144A.

Flower description:

Flower type and flowering habit.—Single terminal and axillary salverform flowers; flowers face mostly upward to outwardly; freely flowering habit with about 70 to 80 developing flowers and open flowers per plant.

Natural flowering season.—Long day responsive; long flowering period, plants flower from early spring until frost in the autumn, flowering continuous during this period; early flowering habit, depending on temperature, plants begin flowering about five to seven weeks after planting rooted young plants. 5

Flower longevity on the plant.—Depending on temperature, about seven to ten days; petals not persistent, and sepals, persistent.

Fragrance.—None detected. 10

Flower buds, before showing petal color.—Length: About 1.6 cm. Diameter: About 3.5 mm to 4 mm. Shape: Oblong, elongate. Texture and luster: Pubescent; slightly glossy. Color, developing sepals: Close to 144A; sutures, close to 145A. 15

Flower diameter.—About 3 cm to 3.2 cm.

Flower depth (height).—About 2.5 cm to 2.75 cm.

Throat diameter.—About 6 mm.

Tube length.—About 1.8 cm to 2 cm.

Tube diameter, distally.—About 6.5 mm to 7 mm. 20

Tube diameter, proximally.—About 2 mm.

Petals.—Quantity and arrangement: Five petals fused in a single salverform whorl. Petal lobe length (from throat): About 1.3 cm to 1.5 cm. Petal lobe width: About 1.4 cm to 1.6 cm. Petal lobe shape: Roughly spatulate. Petal lobe apex: Acute. Petal lobe margin: Entire; slightly undulate. Petal lobe texture and luster, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous; velvety; matte. Petal lobe texture and luster, lower surface: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Throat texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; slightly glossy. Tube texture and luster: Moderately pubescent; matte. Color: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to 68A; towards the throat, close to NN155D; venation, close to 144A to 144B; main color becoming closer to 68B with subsequent development. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to 75B to 75C; venation, close to 144B; color becoming closer to 75C with subsequent development. Flower throat (inside): Close to NN155D; venation, close to 144A to 144B. Flower tube (outside): Close to 144C; venation, close to 144B. 25 30 35 40

Sepals.—Quantity and arrangement: Five sepals fused in a single star-shaped whorl; sepals flaring outwardly. Calyx length: About 1.5 cm to 1.7 cm. Calyx diameter: About 1.5 cm. Length: About 1.5 cm to 1.7 cm. Width: About 2 mm. Shape: Narrowly lanceolate to acicular. Apex: Acute to somewhat rounded. Margin: Entire. Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Moderately pubescent; pubescence, fine; slightly glossy. Color, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144A.

Peduncles.—Length: About 2.4 cm to 2.8 cm. Width: About 1 mm to 1.25 mm. Strength: Moderately strong; wiry and flexible, not brittle. Angle: About 30° to 45° from the stem axis. Texture and luster: Densely pubescent; slightly glossy. Color: Close to 144A.

Reproductive organs.—Stamens: Quantity per flower: About five. Filament length: About 1.7 cm to 1.9 cm. Filament color: Close to NN155D. Anther length: About 1 mm. Anther shape: Bi-lobed. Anther color: Close to 155A. Pollen amount: None observed. Pistils: Quantity per flower: One. Pistil length: About 1.8 cm. Style length: About 1.5 cm. Style color: Proximally, close to 144C to 144D, and distally, close to 144B to 144C. Stigma diameter: About 1 mm. Stigma shape: Round. Stigma color: Close to 144A. Ovary color: Close to 144A.

Seeds and fruits.—To date, seed and fruit development has not been observed on plants of the new *Petunia*.

Pathogen & pest resistance: To date, plants of the new *Petunia* have not been noted to be resistant to pathogens or pests common to *Petunia* plants.

Garden performance: Plants of the new *Petunia* have been observed to have excellent garden performance and have been observed to tolerate rain, wind and temperatures ranging from about 5° C. to about 40° C.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Petunia* plant named ‘WNPETSMVPC26’ as herein illustrated and described.

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FIG. 1

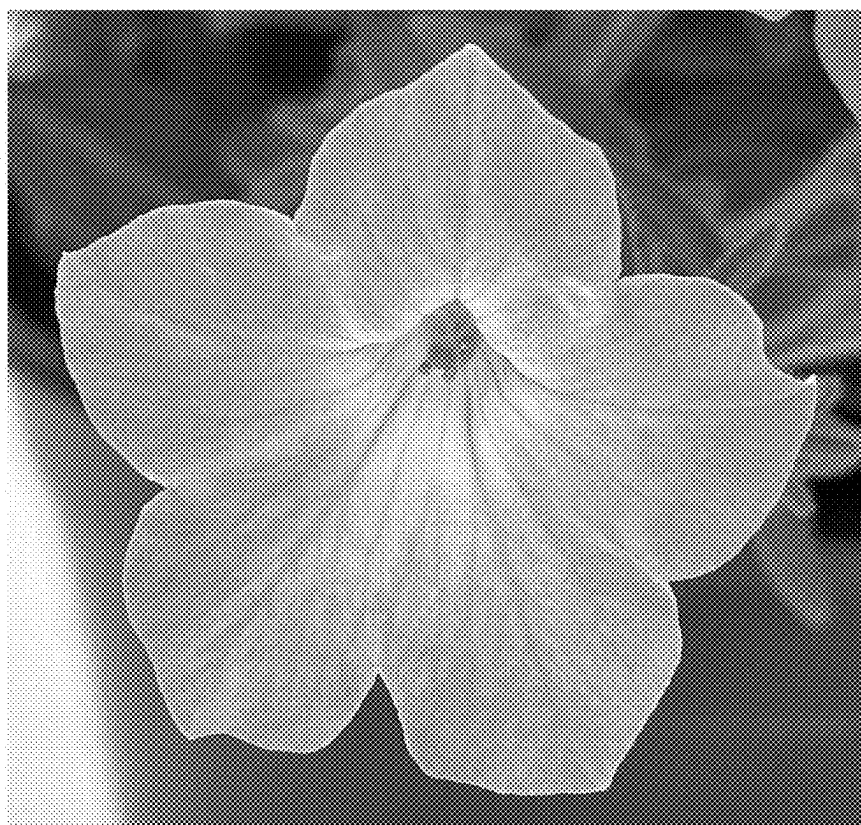


FIG. 2